CB6 TPPS Committee Agenda+Notes May 20 2026

- **6:45 Harvey LaRou from DOT presents plans for Woodhull St., discussion (we'll also ask about plans for the Carroll St. Bridge)**
    - Context
        - Many different projects happening in close proximity: BMT, Red Hook Resiliency, Coastal Resiliency Project, Brooklyn Greenway
    - Issues
        - Weaving: Merging across several lanes
        - Speeding: Three lanes coming off BQE and entering turnaround back onto BQE
        - Pedestrian crossing: 9 blocks between crossings
        - Right turn onto Richards St: High volume of vehicles making illegal right turn (141 over 24 hours)
    - Proposed several treatments
        - One-way conversions, a potential new signal, curb extensions, lane reductions, traffic delineators
    - Comments and questions
        - Concerns about speeding on Hicks Street from Union Street, on Woodhull St, and the turns from highway onto Columbia
        - Requests for hardening to protect pedestrians, reduce parking
        - Safety at midblock crossings
        - Parking will not be reduced as a result of lane reductions
        - Estimated fall 2026
    - Pedestrianizing Carroll St bridge
        - DOT needs a formal letter from BK CB6
    - *Motion to approve all changes presented by DOT on both sides of Hamilton St, with the addition of hawk signals at the midblock crossings*
        - Motion passes unanimously, except for Leroy who abstained for cause
- **7:15 Discussion with Brit Byrd from BP Reynoso's office about a potential Low Traffic Neighborhood (LTN) in Gowanus**

    - Brit Byrd, Senior Planner
        - Supports collaboration with BBP office in terms of exchanging data and building proposal
        - Noted that advocacy is key to unblock LTNs; DOT does not have an LTN program in place
    - Background on LTNs
        - LTNs appeal due to systemwide approach on neighborhood level
        - Evidence of success in Berkeley and London
        - 5th Ave concept: Different “nodes” at 3rd and Union, 9th St, Barclays Center, Prospect Park
        - Note from Doug: BK CB6 has voted in support of an LTN in Gowanus
    - Goal: Figure out ideal boundaries of an LTN in Gowanus
        - This is a purely conceptual exercise
    - Potential boundaries
        - 9th St for southern boundary
    - Comments and questions
        - Transit-forward treatments are possible (e.g., Fulton St)
        - Concerns about congestion on Third Street, but pushback due to Whole Foods parking lot
            - LTNs can have some cutthrough streets
        - Caution against deciding boundaries without a high-exposure meeting, especially with more Gowanus residents
        - Reminder that LTN boundary selection will unavoidably cause someone an inconvenience, should not block the systemic benefits of a boundary
        - Asking about phasing to reduce pain of transition; Brit notes that Gowanus is a naturally occurring LTN due to the canal
        - Idea to improve feasibility with piecemeal projects (e.g., progressively targeting chokepoints, such as pedestrianizing Union St)
- **7:40 Discussion of this proposal from Thomas Neff for a redesign of 8th Avenue, and consideration of a resolution on this**
    - Proposal includes creating a protected bicycle lane and a dedicated bus lane, which both would serve as EMV corridors and be supported by loading/school drop-off zones

        - Includes a block-by-block breakdown
    - Discussion
        - Committee is generally in agreement
        - Could ask for signal timing
        - Should do more community outreach
        - Request for more research; want to balance between preventing induced demand and avoiding pushing harms onto less-active communities
        - Reminder that car usage isn't just from private ownership; delivery and rideshare are drivers as well
        - Note that bus lane is on the left-side of the street, and that bike lanes can go in front of a school
    - Resolution
        - ***Section 1: Low-hanging fruit on 8th Avenue.*** *Reduced speed signal timing to 15mph; painted curb extensions; leading pedestrian intervals; additional hardened daylighting; camera enforcement for speed and red lights.*
        - ***Section 2: Study a traffic redesign of 8th Avenue.*** *Including lane reductions, dedicated bike lanes, additional loading zones, new bus lane configurations, additional traffic calming, additional pedestrian safety features*
    - Motion passed with two abstentions (Leroy and Pauline Blake)
- **8:10: Community presentation**
    - Illegal and dangerous parking at TownePlace Suites by Marriott at 561 President
        - Hotel approved for 5 attended parking spots but routinely has 9-15+ cars parking illegally on sidewalk
        - Multiple videos documented cars backing up on sidewalk, turning around on sidewalk, and pedestrians having to dodge vehicles
        - Jerry suggests getting in touch with the 78th Precinct Community Affairs
- **7:30 TBC: updates from Parks on Red Hook Rec Center and Pool**
    - Parks Dept was not available to present on this
- **New business (5-10 min to propose topics for future discussion)**
    - Follow up on Street Safety form next time